facilitating the integration of these orientations into a more general democratic belief system' (2005, p. 335). Print in her study on youth political participation in Australia noted the importance of both the 'formal' and 'informal' curriculum on citizenship education, that included 'participatory pedagogy', through a more inclusive classroom, 'participatory approaches' that encouraged 'group learning' and engagement outside the classroom, and participatory practices such as 'critical discussion with non/bi-partisan teachers' as key elements in encouraging civic mindedness among the youth (2005, pp. 337–8). However, the citizenship curriculum in Pakistan, far from promoting civic mindedness, has created a narrative of exclusion, emphasizing the importance of the Muslim identity, the superiority of the military in protecting the Islamic Republic, and the role of citizens in supporting the Islamic ideology of the country (Dean 2005; Saigol 2005). As Nelson (2008) in his study of religious education in Pakistan observes, conflating 'Islam' with 'citizenship' as part of school 'syllabi' has resulted in 'religion itself' becoming 'a proxy for a specific construction of religious nationalism' which 'emerges as a relentless push for religious and sectarian homogeneity' (p. 283). Instead of accepting and celebrating a diversity of cultural and religious practices, the citizenship curriculum has imposed a puritanical version of Islamic nationalism in defining the meaning of a Pakistani citizen.[4]

'The role of education in the preservation and inculcation of Islamic values as an instrument of national unity and progress' (Education Policy 1972, as discussed in Khan 1997, p. 650) is a consistent theme across all education policies in Pakistan reinforced through the curriculum, with the Islamization drive of General Zia-ul-Haq making Islam and the notion of a 'good' Muslim a central feature of citizenship as taught in schools. However, there was little or no change made to this central feature of education after the Zia era. According to the Ministry of Education's 1992 report the 'guiding principles' for the National Education Policy 1992 included the following:

> A Muslim population consistently exposed to almost a value-definition western scientific, political and economic thought must be made to imbibe the true spirit of Islam. This brings the educational system into sharp focus. It is through school system alone that human mind can be educated to understand, accept and practice the worldview of Islam. This would require new Islamic curricula for building up the ideological base. (Ministry of Education 1992, p. 5)

Far from promoting a critical worldview, the education system, the curriculum, the textbooks, pedagogy and school ethos all contribute towards citizens who obey those in power without question, where religion in particular is beyond the